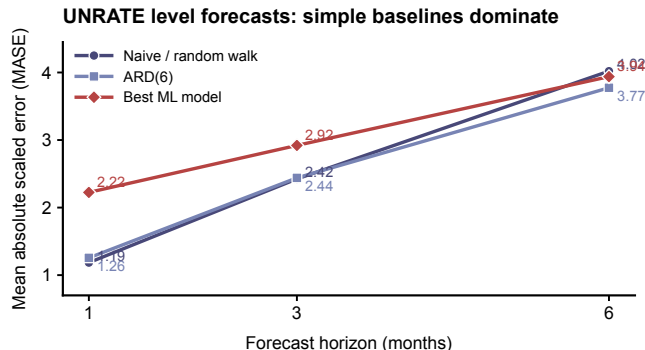


Track B UNRATE: persistence beats richer ML

24-month fixed input window · look-ahead $h \in \{1, 3, 6\}$ months · metric: mean absolute scaled error (MASE)



Track B features use a trailing 24-month fixed input window; lower MASE is better.

Best model by horizon

Lower MASE is better. MAE is in percentage points of unemployment.

h	Model	MAE
1 mo	Naive / Random Walk	0.153 pp
3 mo	Naive / Random Walk	0.313 pp
6 mo	ARD(6)	0.486 pp

Interpretation.

UNRATE levels are highly persistent. With interpretable Track B inputs, richer ML models do not beat the naive/ARD baselines.

Track B: UNRATE level/delta, building